ANSWER KEY

QP CODE: 25901451

MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM

MGU-UGP (HONOURS) REGULAR EXAMINATION March 2026

FOURTH SEMESTER

Discipline Specific Core Course (DSC) - MG4DSCPOL200, MG4DSCPJM200

POLITICAL THEORY

(2024 ADMISSION ONWARDS)

PART A

1. Political Science

2. Liberal Tradition

3. Political Institutions (such as legislature, executive, judiciary, bureaucracy etc.)

4. John Locke/Adam Ferguson/ Alexis de Tocqueville

5. Class/Capitalist

6. State

7. T. H. Marshall

8. Natural Rights

9. Human Rights

10. Robert D. Putnam

PARTB

11.Normative political theory–moral evaluation of institutions–ethical standards for policy–justice as fairness–Rawlsian principles in Indian context–social justice debates– constitutional values–liberty equality fraternity–Directive Principles of State Policy- affirmative action policies–reservation for marginalized groups– poverty inequality analysis–distribution of resources–public welfare and rights–evaluation of state policies–normative critique of social injustice.

12. Decline of political theory debates–post-behavioural critique–reassertion of normative concerns–return to classical questions–justice, liberty, equality– criticism of value neutrality–David Easton's critique of Behaviouralism–Leo Strauss-classical political theory- influence–importance of ethics in politics–integration of empirical and normative analysis–revival of classical thinkers–renewed interest in ideology values democracy.

13. Legal sovereignty–authority recognized by law–constitutional source of power–formal legal supremacy–de jure sovereignty–actual political power–control over state apparatus–ability to enforce decisions–de facto sovereignty– difference between legal authority and real power–constitutional legitimacy versus practical control–example military rule or revolutionary governments.

14.Rejection of absolute sovereignty–critique of monistic state power–society composed of many associations–plural centres of authority–Harold Laski G.D.H. Cole–importance of voluntary associations–church, unions, guilds– state as coordinating institution–decentralization of power–protection of individual freedom–limits on state supremacy.

15. Formal equality before law–legal equality principle–equal treatment regardless of status–absence of discrimination–substantive equality focusses on outcomes–removal of structural disadvantages–affirmative action policies–social justice measures–addressing historical inequality–redistribution of opportunities–equity in resources education employment–balance between legal equality and social fairness.

16. Cultural unity and shared identity–common language history traditions–collective consciousness– Enlightenment ideas of popular sovereignty–self-determination of people–nation as political community–Herder, Rousseau, Mazzini–romantic nationalism–cultural nationalism– modernist interpretations–nation building process–political legitimacy and emotional loyalty.

17. Legitimacy as belief in rightful authority–citizen acceptance of political power–Max Weber's concept– electoral system as source of democratic legitimacy–free and fair elections–representation of people–Election Commission, independence–participation, voter turnout–public trust in institutions– challenges like electoral malpractice money power, identity politics–impact on perceived legitimacy of governance.

18. Crisis of universalism in liberal theory–rise of cultural diversity debates–recognition of marginalized identities–feminism, multiculturalism, postcolonial theory–politics of recognition–influence–ethnicity, gender, religion, language identities–demand for representation–challenge to traditional class politics–plural identities in democracy–debates on inclusion, equality, justice.

19. Emergency governance during pandemic–state authority for public health–restrictions on mobility gatherings– lockdown policies surveillance mechanisms–expansion of executive power– debates on civil liberties privacy rights–freedom of movement expression–balance between security and liberty–judicial oversight public accountability–democratic safeguards during crisis.

20. Critique of liberal individualism–importance of community values–individual shaped by social context–Michael Sandel, Charles Taylor–shared traditions moral bonds– justification of group rights–protection of cultural linguistic minorities–collective autonomy– balance between

individual rights and community identity–multicultural citizenship policies recognition of diversity.

PART C

21.Historical materialism–material conditions shape politics–economic structure determines superstructure–dialectical change in history– class struggle as driving force–bourgeoisie versus proletariat–conflict over means of production–inevitable social transformation–state as instrument of class domination–politics reflecting economic interests–ideology legitimizing ruling class power– critique of capitalism–exploitation- surplus value–alienation of labour–inequality in capitalist production– revolutionary transformation–proletarian revolution–abolition of private property–classless communist society– withering away of the state–collective ownership–egalitarian social relations–emphasis on materialist analysis.

22.Shift from welfare state to regulatory state–globalization influencing governance–economic liberalization policies–rise of neoliberal governance–privatization deregulation reforms–market oriented state functions– growth of international institutions–global governance networks–policy coordination beyond national borders– expansion of security functions–counter terrorism measures–digital surveillance technologies– welfare delivery through targeted schemes–public private partnerships–developmental governance models–digital governance and e governance–data driven policymaking–citizen service platforms–increased role in environmental regulation–climate policy commitments–sustainable development governance– balancing economic growth social welfare security and environmental responsibilities.

23. Popular sovereignty principle–power derived from people–legitimacy through consent–political equality of citizens–universal adult franchise–equal voting rights–representative institutions–elected legislatures–accountable government–rule of law and constitutionalism–protection of civil liberties–fundamental rights guarantees–peaceful transfer of power–regular competitive elections–political pluralism–public participation in decision making–active civil society–freedom of expression–mechanisms of accountability–checks and balances independent judiciary–capacity for reform adaptation–inclusion diversity representation–democratic legitimacy .

24. Concept introduced by Kimberlé Crenshaw–analysis of overlapping identities–multiple forms of discrimination–intersection of race, gender, class–combined structures of oppression–complex social hierarchies–critique of single axis analysis–limitations of traditional feminism–incomplete class based analysis–power relations embedded in institutions–law, policy and social practices–systemic inequality structures–recognition of marginalized experiences–voices of minority women, groups–inclusive social justice framework–application in public policy–equity focused governance–targeted welfare interventions–importance for political representation–diversity in leadership–inclusive democratic participation–broader understanding of inequality–interconnected systems of privilege–multidimensional social analysis.